Buncrana Parish Newsletter ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last week's collection totalled €5,947.
We also gratefully acknowledge a donation of €1000 from Cockhill Ceili Club towards Parish Funds.
Sincere thanks.

Anniversary Masses & Times

ST MARY'S ORATORY
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana
Monday 19 Oct - Mass at 10am
Special Intention
Tuesday 20 Oct - Mass at 10am
Thanksgiving Mass
Wednesday 21 Oct - Mass at 10am
Nora Hegarty
Thursday 22 Oct - Mass at 10am
Special Intention
Saturday 24 Oct - Mass at 4:30pm
Sinead McColgan (MM),
Marie Dunne (MM),
Colm Carey (1st A), plus
Agnes Quinn
Sunday 25 Oct - Mass at 8:30am
Sunday 25 Oct - Mass at 12:30pm

ST. MARY'S, COCKHILL
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill
Friday 23 Oct - Mass at 7pm
Cornelius (60th A) and Margaret (50th A) Doherty
Sunday 25 Oct - Mass at 11am

STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY
Masses streamed on
www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish
Sunday 25 Oct - Mass at 9:45am
Mickey (31st A) and Mary Ellen (25th A) McDaid

BAPTISMS
We welcome into God's Family the following children who were recently baptised:
Ollie James Duddy
Olivia Rose Duddy
May God guide and protect our children always.

DEATHS
Your prayers are asked for
Sr Anna Doherty
Pauline Doyle
who have died recently and for their families & friends saddened by their loss.

WORLD MISSION SUNDAY
Today is the one Sunday in the year when the global Catholic community prays for and supports the missionary activity of the Church. In 2026, this annual celebration reaches a significant milestone: its 100th anniversary. On this special day, the Holy Father invites all Catholics to support the work of Missio, his charity for world mission, through a special collection. This day of prayer, solidarity, and giving unites Catholics worldwide to share the Good News of God's love – news which has the power to transform lives and heal our world. Thank you for your prayers, generosity and support.

Priest on Call 074 9361253

Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com
Website: www.buncranaparish.com
Twenty-Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time
18 October 2026
Mission Sunday

BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER AT FATHER HEGARTY'S ROCK
Only three weeks after his installation as Bishop of Derry, The Most Reverend Michael Router paid a pastoral visit last Sunday to the parishes of Burt, Inch & Fahan and Desertegney & Lower Fahan (Buncrana). We were delighted to have him amongst us on what was an unseasonably warm and sunny day, for what was a spectacularly wonderful occasion. He walked with us on a Synodal walk from the Stone Jug and celebrated Mass on Father Hegarty's Rock, before returning then to Cockhill Parish Hall for tea and refreshments.

The turnout was splendid, the welcome warm, the support immense and the faith tangible. In the midst of a sometimes stiff Atlantic breeze he joked about not being blown into the water, seemingly perched as he was on the edge of the Lough. But from there he commanded a great view of the gathering and the Statue of Friar Seamus Hegarty OP – and he offered a most memorable Mass recalling the courage and hope which Father Hegarty had in abundance, and asking God to grant us the same gifts for the challenges in our own time. The music and singing were outstanding and the joy and contentment of those gathered there, of all ages, was clear to be seen. After visiting Father Walsh in his home, the bishop returned to Derry with a spring in his step and firm in the knowledge that he will always be welcome in these parts.

It was a truly wonderful occasion made possible only by the devotion and help of huge teams of people: our stewards and volunteers, choirs and musicians, farmers and bakers, schools and Parents' Associations (especially at St Oran's NS), and to all who came to celebrate. To them all and to God himself, we must always be thankful.

Father Bradley

THROWING OPEN THE DOORS TO CHRIST NOVENA
This year's Novena begins next Sunday 25 October at 7pm in St Mary's Church, Cockhill.
For the nine Sundays before Christmas we will gather for one hour and the ceremony will comprise of the Rosary, a talk given by an invited speaker, the Novena prayer and petitions (which can be placed in a box at the door of the church), a Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and finishing with Benediction of the Most Blessed Sacrament.
Once again, the theme of this year's Novena is "Throwing Open the Doors to Christ" – taken from the homily of Pope St John Paul II at the Opening Mass of his Pontificate on 22 October 1978.
The first Guest speaker on the opening night will be Bishop Michael Router. All are very welcome. Please come along, bring your families and make the most of this opportunity for prayer as we approach the season of Christ's birth.
(The Holy Hour each Sunday evening in St Mary's Oratory will cease for the moment, resuming after Christmas.)

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Walsh 9361393
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9361253
Parish Catechist 086 785 3726

ADORATION CHAPEL
Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel
Sunday 2pm - 10pm
Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm
Friday 6am - 10pm
ADORERS NEEDED
There are many hours in the Adoration Chapel that are sparsely filled; Fridays are especially quiet. Please consider giving an hour. If you can commit to one hour per week, please fill out a card on the table at the Adoration Chapel to be added to the Adoration Register. Thank you.

GUIDED HOLY HOUR
The Holy Hour continues on Sunday evening at 6pm in the Oratory. It will pause during the Novena from next week on and resume after Christmas.

STATION MASSES
Station Masses have resumed in the month of October throughout the Parish of Desertegney & Lower Fahan (including in the town area). If you wish to have a Station Mass please contact the Parish Office on a first come, first served basis.
Fr Bradley
There will be a Station Mass on **Thurs 22 Oct** in Loretta Jones' home, 26 St John's Park, F93 TF60 covering the Ludden, Gransha, Ballymacarry Lower and Trillick areas. Confessions from 7:30pm with Mass at 8pm.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS
St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."

DERRY DIOCESAN YOUNG ADULT COMMUNITY
Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tues evening at 7:30pm, starting 20 Oct, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.

NEW ALTAR SERVERS
We are again recruiting new altar servers so any pupil currently in 3rd Class or older, and who have made their First Holy Communion are welcome to apply. Application forms can be obtained from schools.

PARISH DRAW

Friday 2 October: Week 16
1st Prize: €500
Annie Kelly, Cockhill Park
Promoter: Marie Henderson
2nd Prize: €300
Olive Doherty, Linsfort
Promoter: Annemarie Doherty
3rd Prize: €150
Theresa Bradley, Stragill
Promoter: Fr Francis Bradley

LECTIO DIVINA (Praying with Scripture) takes place each Wed after 10am Mass in St Teresa's Room. Come and join us for a cuppa and prayer.
GLOBAL ROSARY FOR PEACE will take place on Thursday 22 October at 7pm at the Oratory Grotto. All welcome
THORNHILL MINISTRIES will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. '*Open heart - Open to the Word*' series of 4 Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome
SCOIL ÍOSAGÁIN: ENROLMENT/Application Forms for children starting school in Sept 2027 are available from Mon 12th Oct from the school Reception (entrance opposite the Grotto). Closing date for receipt of applications is Fri 13 Nov at 3pm. For further information please ring the school at 0749362450 or contact principal@scoiliosagain.ie
CHARITY DANCE PTSB Buncrana are hosting a Charity Dance in aid of iCare and the Alzheimer's Society on Mon 19 Oct between 7pm – 11pm. Adm by Donation only and Raffle on the night - hosted By Hugo Duncan. Performers include Brian Kerrrigan, Damien Davis, Martin Cuffe, Stevie Mac, Amber Campbell, Jack Larry, Jason McCahill, Micheala Harkin, Eddie Gallagher. All Welcome
SOCIAL TEA DANCE Eamon Cutliffe's 80th birthday social tea dance with Revival Band and guests Maria Fitzpatrick, Caroline Cutliffe, and Bernie Doherty on Sun 25 Oct at The Plaza Buncrana. 8pm-10pm Adm €10. Come along and hear all your favourite songs, jiving, line dancing and dance tunes.
MARY'S MEALS If you have any old notes or coins that you wish to donate to Mary's Meals, they can be dropped off to Mc Kenna's Londis, Buncrana on Fri 31 Oct between 9.30am and 5.30pm. Otherwise, collection can be arranged by contacting Eilis Conneely on 0877060457. Thank you for your kind support.
COFFEE MORNING Fionán Bradley is holding a coffee morning in St Mary's Hall, Buncrana on Fri 30 Oct from 10am-2pm as part of his fundraising efforts for Buncrana GAA's Quid Games. Fionán's chosen charity is Buncrana Community Hospital. Anyone willing to bake something for the coffee morning please give him a call on 0861245348

BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.buncranacinema.ie

Get the latest show times straight to your inbox: Buncranacinema.ie/subscribe

Forever is Now 12A | 100mins Sat 17th & Sun 18th 8:15pm Mon 19th & Tues 20th - 8:15pm	**Shaun The Sheep** G | 80mins Sat 17th - 5pm Matinee Sun 18th - 3pm	**Everybody Diggs Bill Evans** 15A | 100mins Sun 18th - 5pm	**NT:LIVE FRANKENSTEIN** Wed 21st & Thurs 22nd - 8:15pm Tickets €12 at the door

BINGO

St Mary's Hall
Fridays at 8pm
Single book €11
Double €17
Snowball: €5500

Community Corner

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE Drumfries Walking Group will be meeting on Fri 23 Oct at Clonmany car park, at 10am everyone welcome. We are holding our **Christmas Craft Fair** on Sat 28 Nov from 2-5pm. If you would like to book the last remaining table at this event, please contact the Centre on 0749361742. **Drop in Craft Class**, weekly on a Wed 10:30am-12:30pm. (Sewing / Embroidery/ Knitting) no tutor, just a group of like minded people supporting each other while enjoying a cup of tea and a chat, bring your own materials and sewing machine. €3 per class. Contact the centre on 0749361742 for more information
THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst consults with parents of children 3-12 years of age (with or without a diagnosis) to help their child accept 'no', listen, regulate their big emotions etc. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa's Room.
AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else's drinking) meet in St Teresa's Room on Thurs at 6:45pm.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa's Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329.
THE PLAZA Dance Classes *Tues* from 10:30am. From ***Wed:*** **Junior Line Dancing & Jiving Class** 5pm-6pm. **Beginners Line Dancing** 6:15pm-7:15pm. **Advanced Line Dancing** 7:30pm-8:30pm. ***Mon:*** **A Beginners Line Dancing and Jiving Class** at the Laurentic 7:30pm-9pm. Hall available for hire & for children's birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317
INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. HSE encourages parents to protect babies this winter. Inishowen Medical is hosting **RSV vaccination clinics** in early October. Parents of babies born between the 1st Mar and 31st Aug 2026, who wish to avail of this vaccine, should contact us to book a vaccine apt with Nurse/Midwife Fogarty.
RACHEL'S VINEYARD Have you been affected or hurt by abortion? Please contact Michelle on 00447871765181
NOWDOC Phone Number: 0818400911

SLIMMING WORLD Buncrana: **The Exchange** every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall** every Thurs at 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Newtowncunningham: The Orange Hall** every Wed at 6.30pm with Ann Marie 0860848705.
INISHOWEN INJURY CLINIC Treatment of back, neck and shoulder pain / sports injuries / rehabilitation. Contact Cahir McLaughlin NMT, Maginn Ave 0860753296
PARK RUN Come and join the us on Saturday mornings at 9am on the shore front by the play park.
GENTLE EXERCISE CLASS for people living with Parkinson's every Wednesday at 2pm in The Exchange.
COCKHILL CEILI CLUB Classes on Thursdays in Cockhill Hall. 8pm-9.30pm. Beginners Welcome.
GAELSCOIL BHUN CRANNCHA Give us a call on 074 9361988 or email gsbc1999@gmail.com to discuss how an Irish medium education can benefit your child. If you don't speak Irish, don't worry. That won't hold your child back.
COMMUNITY EMPLOYMENT PROGRAMME Vacancies for a grounds worker for the graveyard at St Mary's Cockhill. Contact buncrana@swillycep.ie for more info
BUNCRANA PARENT AND TODDLERS' GROUP Wednesdays and Thursdays from 10am to 11:45am in St Mary's Hall.
CRAZY PAVING EXPERT Buncrana Area call 0871923511
FOUND A Nissan car key near Tullydish Bridge. Contact 0860686048
IRISH GRINDS specialising in Oral and Grammar for LC. Wednesday availability. Experienced Tutor. WhatsApp: +353 0872408308
BUNCRANA COMMUNITY LIBRARY has a reusable party pack available to borrow with your library card. This contains: plates, cups, jugs, trays, bowls, bunting and cutlery. Ring 074 93 61941 for further info
BUNCRANA LIBRARY Chess playing meet ups takes place on Saturdays in Buncrana Community library from 11am to 1 pm. No bookings required just drop in. All ages welcome. Ring 0749361941 for further info.
SWILLY GARDENING CLUB Our next Meeting will take place on Mon 19 Oct @ 8pm in the Buncrana Youth club (Boy's Club) F93 HW6K.We will be making Bird/hedgehog boxes as previously arranged. New Members welcome. Any queries text Anne 0879560134.
SAMARITANS Call Free **116 123,** Text **087 2609090.**

PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary's Oratory and St Mary's Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary's Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary's Cockhill.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Síochána,** Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 00353 749102233 **ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108**